

Response Rate Analysis (Fall 2021 – Spring 2025)

Objective

To develop a clearer understanding of response rate trends across semesters and identify key gaps or pain points in participation.

Data Scope

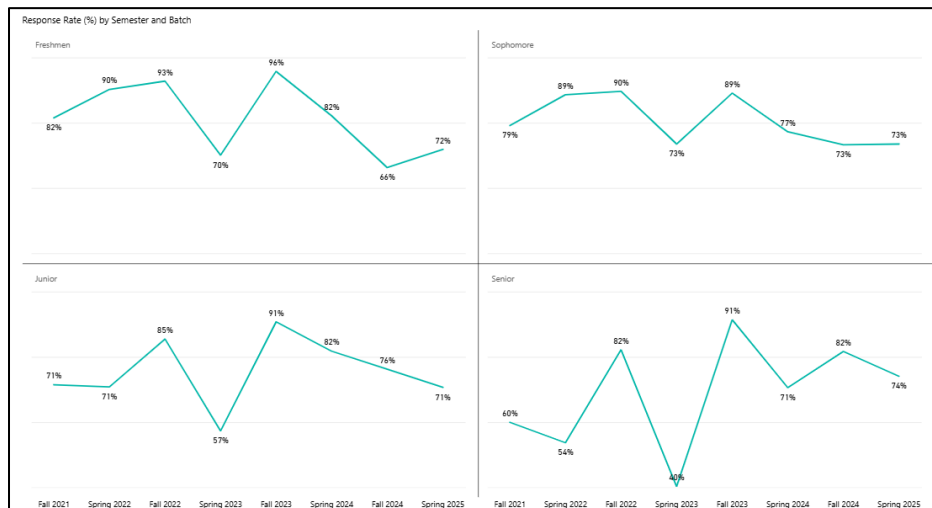
The analysis covers student response rates from **Fall 2021 to Spring 2025**, incorporating details on:

- Semester-wise trends
- Batch-wise comparisons
- Course categories
- Faculty designations
- Course levels (100, 200, 300, 400)
- Program-level insights

Overall Response Rate Trends

Response rates generally stayed above 70%, with Spring 2023 as a notable exception when reminders and incentives were **not** enforced. The sharp rebound in Fall 2023 demonstrates the **effectiveness of structured interventions** such as **weekly reminders** and a **revised evaluation process**. Yet, the subsequent decline across most cohorts—even when class time was allotted—suggests either diminishing returns from these measures or a **general disengagement** that seems to be **cohort specific**. Perhaps, the presence of instructors during allotted time may also have influenced student behavior, leading some to provide perfunctory responses or avoid submission altogether.

For seniors, response rates follow a clear semester pattern—rising in Fall and dropping in Spring. The recurring Spring dips likely reflect end-of-program pressures: with limited time, lower stakes, and reduced incentives as graduation approaches, seniors appear less motivated to provide feedback as they near graduation in Spring semesters.

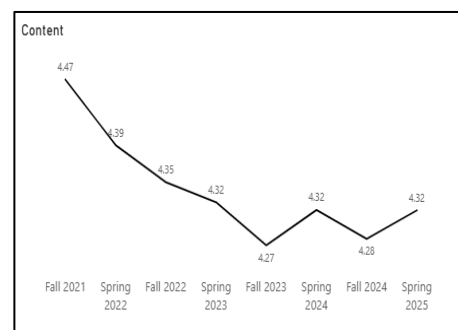
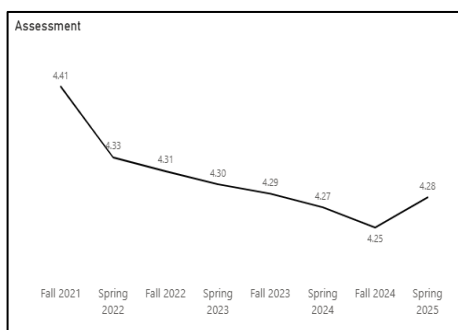
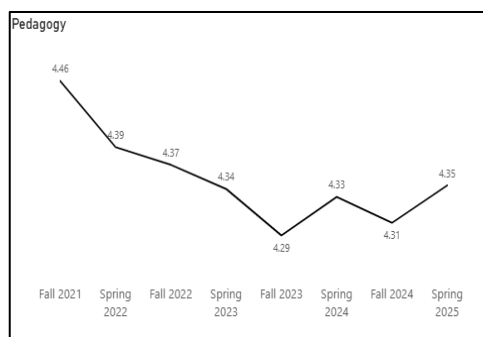


To this effect, the report focuses on the specific categories and groups that may represent potential pain points. The relative **stability among seniors and sophomores** (their overall rates have improved gradually overtime) suggests that the issue is not uniform across the student body. Instead, program- or cohort-specific

factors are likely at play, meaning that attributing the **overall downward trend** solely to general disengagement would provide an incomplete explanation.

Changes in Response by Student Year and Schools

Across all semesters, **response rates decline** across batches **after Fall 2023**, suggesting possible **cohort-specific** dissatisfaction. While these shifts could stem from **two** factors—**student disengagement over time** or the **impact of changing batch sizes**—the evidence points more strongly to disengagement. Even when **batch sizes** remain **comparable**, response rates **fluctuate sharply**, indicating that the downward trend is **less about cohort size** and more about **declining willingness to respond** which may be associated with cohort-specific dissatisfaction with course content, pedagogy, or assessment, which has been declining over time.



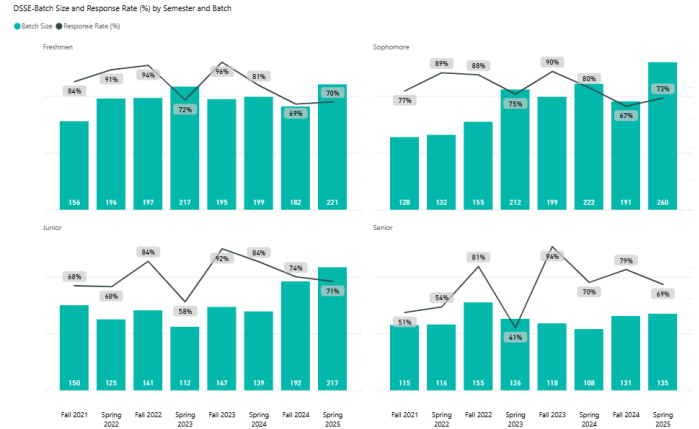
In AHSS, there has been a pronounced response rate decline amongst **freshmen and juniors**, marking a shift from earlier patterns when seniors were least responsive. While **seniors** still have somewhat lower absolute numbers, their **response rate** has been **improving** overtime.

AHSS-Batch Size and Response Rate (%) by Semester and Batch



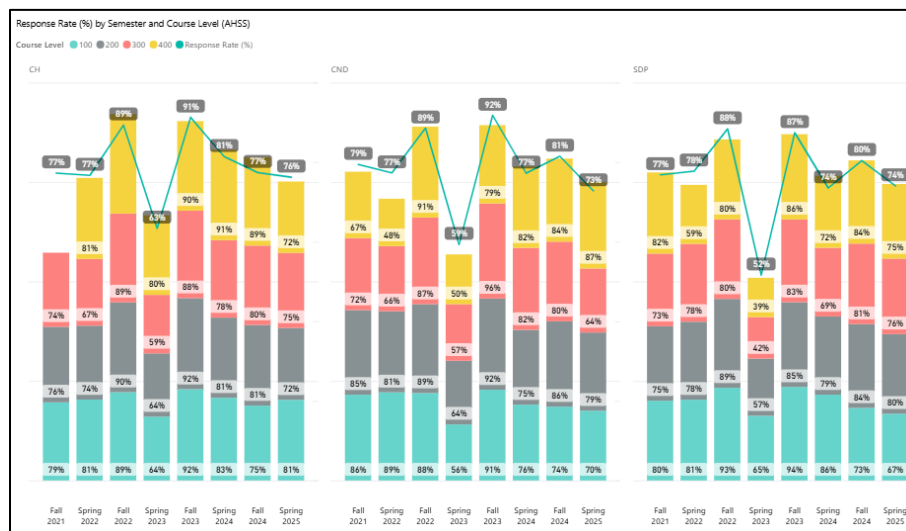
In DSSE, **freshmen, juniors, and seniors** record the lowest overall participation rates. Seniors have **historically** been **weak responders**, though their rates show **modest improvement in Fall** semesters.

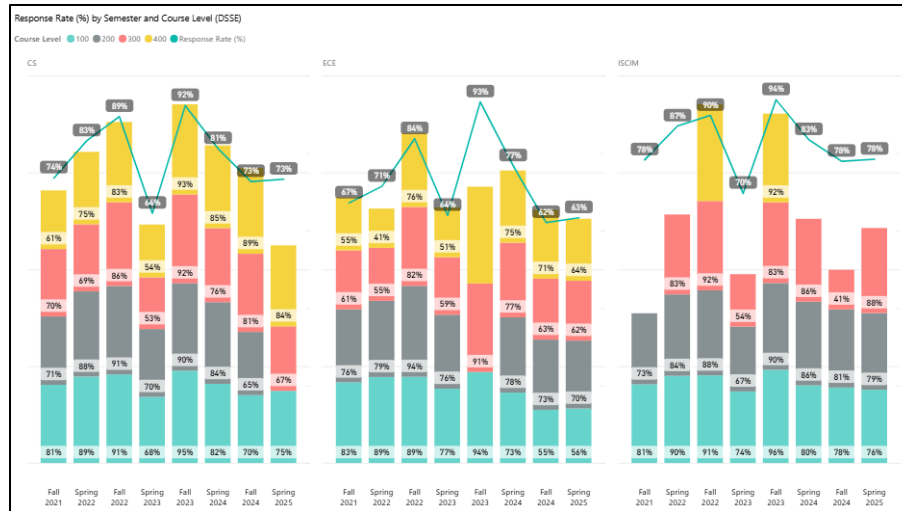
Freshmen, by contrast, maintained historically high engagement until Fall 2023, after which their **response rates declined sharply**. This drop cannot be explained by **batch size alone**, as **similar cohort sizes** in earlier years produced higher response rates. **Juniors**, meanwhile, exhibit a **steady downward trend** with no signs of recovery across semesters.



After controlling for other factors, however, the regression analysis suggests that freshmen are the most responsive group compared to other batches, in the absence of variables such as semester, program, and course level. Indeed then, while their response rates have declined in recent semesters, freshmen still generate higher absolute numbers of responses. In contrast, **Juniors are about 26% less likely to respond than freshmen**, and **seniors are nearly 50% less likely**, controlling for all other effects.

Course-Level Variations



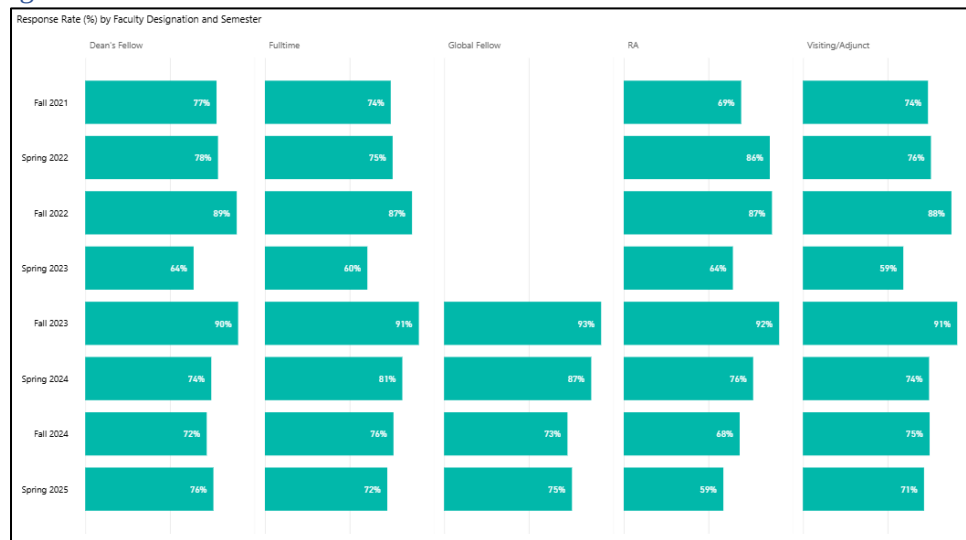


A clear trend shift is visible post-Fall 2023 across all programs. However, the declines have been steeper for both ECE and SDP, which is also substantiated in the logistic regression which shows that compared to an arbitrary program, for example Comparative Humanities, students in **ECE were about 27% less likely to respond**, while **SDP students are 10% less likely to respond**.

In SDP particularly, post-Fall 2023 which saw the peak across all programs, the response rate for 100 and 400 level courses has consistently been declining. For advanced level courses, however, this pattern cannot be generalized to AHSS as a whole—**contrasting trends in CH (AHSS) show higher response rates in higher-level courses**, suggesting increased willingness to respond as students progress.

A similar post-Fall 2023 decline appears in ECE (DSSE), where the weakest responses occur in 100- and 300-level courses. For higher level courses, this is not reflective of DSSE overall, as **CS (DSSE) maintains stronger engagement at the 300- and 400-levels**, in contrast to ECE's downward trajectory at higher levels. In fact, the regression analysis suggests that students in 400 level courses are **9% more likely** to participate than those in 100-level courses, suggesting that advanced courses may foster greater investment in feedback as they may be more specialized in terms of their content which may contribute to greater student engagement.

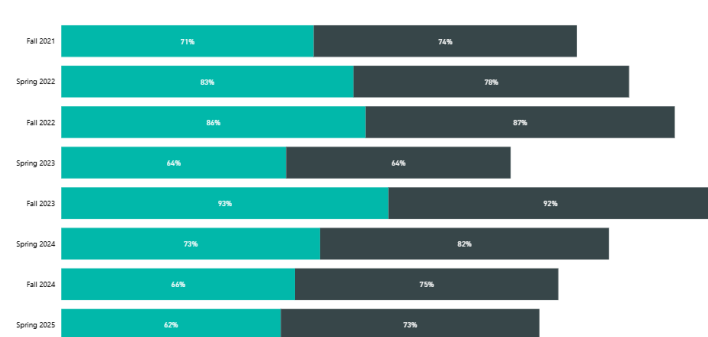
Faculty Designation Effects



Response rates **across designations** generally **remain strong** (above 70%), hinting that designation alone may not drive student engagement. Still, as per regression analysis, keeping all else constant, full-time faculty tend to secure up **to 21% higher participation than Visiting/Adjunct faculty**—perhaps because permanent faculty usually have had more time to acclimatize to student and university culture and expectations. more actively encourage responses. Global and Dean’s Fellows initially attracted high participation, as their numbers were fairly low in the initial years, but the overall trend is still above 70%.

The trend seems to be declining the most for Research Assistants (RAs). Their teaching is often tied to labs or support courses, which students may view as less formal, and their transient role could mean students perceive less value in providing evaluations. **This aligns with the broader trend of lower response rates for Labs compared to Lectures.**

Response Rate (%) by Semester and Course Component
Course_Component: LAB, LEC



Summary:

Target Groups with lowest responses					
School	Batch	Program	Course Level	Faculty Designation	Course Component
AHSS	Freshmen & Juniors	SDP	100 & 400	Visiting/Adjunct	NA
DSSE	Freshmen, Juniors and Seniors	ECE	100 & 300	Visiting/Adjunct & RAs	Labs

Overall response rates have generally remained **above 70%**, with **Spring 2023** as a **notable exception** when reminders and incentives were not enforced. The sharp rebound in Fall 2023 demonstrates the **effectiveness of structured interventions**, but subsequent declines—even when class time was allotted—may suggest **diminishing returns from these measures**, **broader student disengagement**, or **cohort-specific factors**.

Participation patterns highlight that the issue is not uniform across the student body. **Freshmen**, historically strong responders, now **show the steepest decline since Fall 2023**, pointing to **possible dissatisfaction with course content, pedagogy, or assessment**. **Seniors** remain low responders but show **modest improvement**, while sophomores appear relatively stable.

At the school level, **AHSS freshmen** and **juniors** now record the **weakest engagement**, while in **DSSE the lowest rates** are among **freshmen, juniors and seniors**. Course-level patterns further confirm variation: in **AHSS**, **SDP** shows low participation in **100-** and **400-level** courses; in **DSSE**, **ECE** reflects weaker participation in **100-** and **300-levels**.

Faculty designation also appears to shape engagement, although minimally. **Full-time faculty** consistently receive the highest **response rates** whereas **Visiting/Adjunct** faculty are more **volatile**, likely due to their temporary roles and the time it may take them to acclimatize to university and classroom culture. **Research Assistants** show a downward trend owing to their affiliation with labs, where response rates are already weaker compared to lectures.

Taken together, the evidence suggests that declining participation stems from both **general disengagement in newer cohorts** (reflective in declining ratings on Content, Pedagogy, Assessment) and **program (course and level), cohort, and somewhat designation** dynamics. Addressing this challenge will require targeted interventions that go beyond procedural adjustments, focusing instead on strengthening structural and pedagogical alignment.